Theme: Stories - When the Water Rises

Date: 18 September 2026 **Duty Six: Red**

Time	Min	Activity	Equipment	Scouter
18h00	5	**GRAND HOWL** Flag Register Break	Skin/Flag Flag pole Register	Kaa Red Six
Every good story begins with a setting. Tonight our story begins beside a peaceful little river. But rivers do not always stay peaceful...				
18h05	10	**Steam Release: THE RIVER IS RISING!** Drizzle - walk and tap fingers. Rain - jog and pat knees. Storm - run. River - move to the riverbank. FLOOD! - get to high ground. No elimination; the last Cub to safety calls the next round.	Cones / rope Hoops / mats	Rikki All
The Cubs in our story have reached high ground. Looking down into the valley, they see a little village below. What will happen when all that water reaches it?				
18h15	25	**NATIONAL CHALLENGE: FLOOD IN A TRAY - BUILD & TEST 1** In Sixes, build a small landscape with a river or watercourse, houses, people/animals, vegetation or farmland and other village features. Create the first storm using the same measured quantity of water for each Six. Observe what floods, washes away, survives and where people would be safest.	Large shallow trays Sand / soil Stones Twigs / leaves Blocks / model houses People / animals Jug + measured water Towels	Rikki All
18h40	5	WATER BREAK Quick drink and toilet break. Use the buddy system.	Water bottles	All
The villagers survived their first storm, but their story is not finished. They now know what went wrong - and another storm is coming. Refreshed and ready, they have a chance to change the ending.				
18h45	15	**NATIONAL CHALLENGE: FLOOD IN A TRAY - REBUILD & TEST 2** The weather service warns of another storm. Redesign the village to make it safer: move buildings to higher ground, strengthen banks, add barriers or drainage, plant vegetation, redirect water or raise structures. Repeat the flood with the SAME amount of water and compare the results.	Original trays Extra stones / sticks Cardboard / straws Clay / Prestik Vegetation Measured water	Kaa All
We cannot always stand beside someone to warn them when water becomes dangerous. Sometimes the best way to keep people safe is to share what we know - especially with younger children.				
19h00	20	**NATIONAL CHALLENGE: WATER SAFETY AWARENESS POSTER** Each Six creates a colourful poster suitable for Meerkats or a local ECD. Keep messages short and clear, e.g. never go near water without a grown-up; never push anyone into water; stay away from rivers/drains when water rises; if someone is in trouble CALL AN ADULT - do not jump in; listen to warnings and move to safety. Choose Cubs to present it later to the Meerkats/ECD.	A3 paper / card Kokis / crayons Pencils / rulers Glue Pictures / cut-outs	Raksha All
Our Cubs have built a village, watched a disaster happen, rebuilt it and found a way to warn other people. Before we pass the story on, there is one more story to hear.				
19h20	4	**YARN: THE STORY THE RIVER TOLD** (See yarn below.)	Yarn	Rikki
Every story leaves us with something to remember. Tonight the river reminds us that we cannot always stop water, but we can recognise danger, prepare and help other people stay safe. Now it is your turn to pass the story on.				
19h24	6	**POSTER STORYTELLING PRACTICE** Each Six has about 1 minute to show its poster to the Pack and practise explaining the message to younger children. Do not just read it - tell the water-safety story in your own words.	Completed posters	All
Tonight our Sixes have become builders, problem-solvers and storytellers. The village survived because people learnt from what happened - and now you can use your story to help somebody else stay safe around water. Now it is time to join the Scouts and carry our stories to the campfire.				
19h30	30	**COMBINED CAMPFIRE WITH SCOUTS**	Campfire requirements	Cubs & Scouts

YARN - The Story the River Told (about 4 minutes)

Once there was a little village built beside a river. Most of the year the river was so quiet that the children hardly noticed it. They crossed the little bridge on their way to school, families picnicked beside it and cattle drank from the shallow water.

An old woman called Gogo Thandi lived on the highest hill overlooking the village. Whenever the summer clouds began gathering, she told the children, “Always respect the river. A quiet river can have a very loud story to tell.”

The children thought this was strange. “How can a river tell a story?” they asked. Gogo Thandi smiled. “You have to learn how to listen.”

One afternoon enormous grey clouds filled the sky. The rain began. At first it was wonderful. The children splashed in puddles and watched little streams run along the road. But the rain did not stop. The little river became wider. Then faster.

One boy, Sipho, ran towards the bridge. “I want to see the flood!” he shouted. His friend Naledi grabbed his arm. “Remember Gogo’s story. If the river is getting bigger, we go AWAY from it, not towards it.” They hurried uphill.

From the hill they watched branches, rubbish and even part of a fence rush underneath the bridge. Then the bridge disappeared beneath the muddy water. Sipho stared at it. “I cross there every day,” he whispered. Gogo Thandi nodded. “And today you didn’t.”

The storm eventually passed and the river slowly returned to normal. The next morning the children walked down with the adults. Water had carved away part of the riverbank. A small shed built close to the river had disappeared. But the houses on higher ground were safe.

Sipho looked at Gogo Thandi. “I think I heard the river’s story.” “What did it say?” she asked. Sipho thought. “It said that water is stronger than I am.” Naledi added, “And being curious isn’t worth getting hurt.”

Gogo smiled. “And what will you do the next time the river begins telling that story?” Every child answered together: “Move away from the water, get to a safe place and tell an adult.”

From that day on, whenever clouds gathered over the village, the children did not just watch the rain. They listened to the story the river was telling.

National Challenge / Scouter Notes

- Flood in a Tray: Cubs build and flood their landscape, observe the effects, make improvements and test it again.
- Water Safety Awareness: Create a poster raising awareness on water safety and present it to Meerkats or your local ECD. Friday’s 1-minute Pack presentations are rehearsal; keep the posters so the actual Meerkat/ECD presentation can still be completed.
- Keep the water quantity and pouring point the same for Test 1 and Test 2 so the Cubs can compare their changes fairly.